SOC INVESTIGATION REPORT

Unauthorized Account Creation & Privilege Escalation
March 28, 2026
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1. Executive Summary

This investigation simulates a post-compromise scenario in which an attacker establishes persistence within a Windows domain environment. A backdoor account was created, enabled, and elevated to Domain Administrator privileges. Using Wazuh SIEM, the activity was successfully detected, correlated, and visualized across multiple systems.

2. Environment

SIEM: Wazuh
Domain Controller: Windows Server 2022 (SOC-DC01)
Attacker Machine: Kali Linux
Target Systems: Windows 10, Ubuntu Server

3. Attack Simulation

Created two domain user accounts: backdoor1 and a secondary backdoor account (for persistence redundancy)
Enabled the account
Added the account to the Domain Admins group
Logged into the environment using the new account

4. Detection & Logs

4720 – User account created
4722 – User account enabled
4738 – Account modified
4624 – Successful logon

5. Analysis

Account creation originated from administrative context
Privilege escalation occurred shortly after creation
Successful logon confirmed attacker access
Activity was visible across domain controller and endpoints

6. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

The observed attacker behavior maps to the following MITRE ATT&CK techniques:

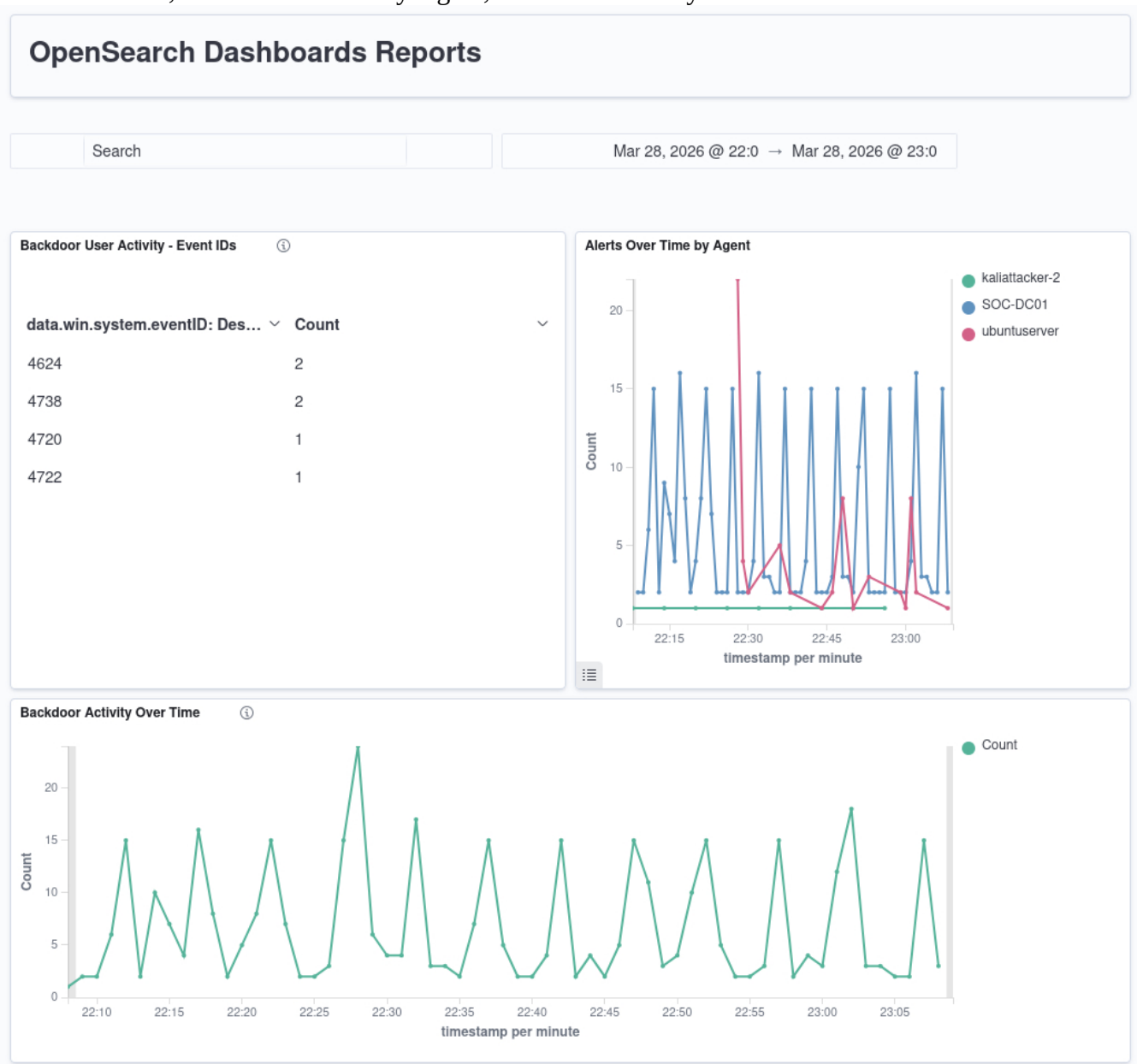
- **T1136 – Create Account**
  Multiple domain accounts were created (`backdoor1 and an additional account`) to establish redundant persistence. This technique ensures continued access in the event one account is discovered or removed.

- **T1098 – Account Manipulation**
  Modification of account privileges by adding the user to the Domain Admins group.
- **T1078 – Valid Accounts**
  Use of legitimate credentials to authenticate and access the environment.
- **T1059 – Command and Scripting Interpreter**
  Use of command-line tools (e.g., net user, net group, runas) to execute actions.

These techniques indicate a pot-compromise scenario consistent with real-world attacker behavior.

7. Visualization

Event ID Table, Alerts Over Time by Agent, Backdoor Activity Timeline



8. Findings

Unauthorized account creation was detected
Privilege escalation to Domain Admins was confirmed
Attacker activity was successfully tracked
Timeline shows sequence of events

9. Conclusion

This investigation demonstrates how SIEM tools such as Wazuh can detect and visualize attacker behavior.

10. Recommendations

Monitor Event IDs 4720, 4722, 4738, 4624
Alert on privileged group additions
Apply least privilege
Review account logs regularly